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Los Angeles County - Here's who's running in local Assembly races

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Here's a glimpse of Assembly races coming up on Nov. 3 that involve Los Angeles County voters.

District 36: Tom Lackey (R) vs. Steve Fox (D)

• The district: Encompasses a wide swath of people in Eastern Kern, Northern L.A., and Western San Bernardino counties, and includes the cities of California City, Mojave, Rosamond, Acton, Lancaster, Littlerock, Palmdale, Quartz Hill, Piñon Hills, Wrightwood, and parts of Phelan.

• The incumbent: Tom Lackey, the Republican from Palmdale, was originally a special education teacher before he became a California Highway Patrolman for 28 years. Sometimes portrayed as one of the Assembly's more moderate Republicans, Lackey spent 2019 voting against measures that would increase oversight over the police and sheriff's departments, voting against environmental protections, and voting against the rights of tenants. Motorists might recognize him as the author of the bill that legalized lane-splitting.

• The challenger: Steve Fox, last decade's main challenger to Lackey, was not endorsed by the Democratic Party this year. Also from Palmdale, Fox was sued twice in 2014 by two former employees; one alleging he created a hostile work environment and exposed himself to her, and the other for unpaid wages. Fox denies the allegations, but both suits were settled, and the costs were paid by the Assembly to the tune of $210,000.

District 70: Patrick O'Donnell (D) vs. David Thomas (R)

• The district: District 70 runs along the coast and ports of L.A. County, and includes approximately 468,514 residents in Avalon, Long Beach, L.A., San Pedro, and Signal Hill.

• The Incumbent: Patrick O'Donnell stands up for public education and labor, and not much else. He regularly abstains from tough votes, often against the will of his progressive district. He is notoriously difficult to get a hold of by his constituents.

• The Challenger: Dave Thomas is a construction manager for L.A. County Beach and harbors. He says he is pro-life and believes that climate change is a hoax. He identifies bureaucracy as a problem that saps up budgets meant for issues helping the homeless, he wants to end overspending, and he wants California to open for business again after closing due to the pandemic.

District 66: Al Muratsuchi (D) vs. Arthur Schaper (R)

• The District: District 66 is home to approximately 467,745 people living in Alondra Park, Hermosa Beach, Lomita, Manhattan Beach, Palos Verdes Estates, Racho Palos Verdes, Redondo Beach, Rolling Hills, Rolling Hills Estates, Torrance, West Carson, and portions of Gardena, Harbor City and Harbor Gateway.

• The Incumbent: Al Muratsuchi (D-Rolling Hills Estates) has a mixed record over the last year, during which he voted for measures that capped rent increases at 5% a year, and forces debt collectors to leave the final $1,724 in bank accounts, but he also voted against bills that allow formerly incarcerated people to serve on juries, and expedited the process to obtain records of police misconduct in criminal trials. He's received $31,000 in campaign contributions from the Los Angeles Police Protective League, and $37,000 from PORAC, which is the largest statewide law enforcement organization.

• The Challenger: Arthur Schaper is running as a Republican, and has only managed to raise around $1,800 dollars for his campaign. Schaper, a supporter of President Donald Trump and a blogger, is against same-sex marriage, transgender bathroom rights, illegal immigration, and sex education in schools, which he claims was “foisted on us by the LGBTQ agenda.”

District 64: Mike Gipson (D) vs. Fatima Iqbal-Zubair (D)

• The District: The 64th State Assembly District covers parts of South L.A. and the South Bay, including the cities of Carson, Compton, Rancho Dominguez (East and West), Willowbrook, and parts of Long Beach, Broadway-Manchester, Harbor Gateway, Watts and Wilmington.

• The Incumbent: Mike Gipson, D-Carson, recently sponsored a bill to establish civilian oversight over sheriff’s departments. In 2019 he voted no on a bill that would improve transparency concerning the environmental impact of abandoned oil wells. Over the years, Mike Gipson received a total of $146,008 from the pharmaceutical industry, and $170,780 from the oil and gas industry, though most of his contributions are from labor unions.

• The Challenger: Fatima Iqbal-Zubair, D-Watts, a teacher, was endorsed this year by the Democratic Socialists of America, Ground Game LA, and the Sunrise Movement, and she is running on a platform of Medicare-for-all, clean air and water in her district, and ending systemic racism. The majority of contributions to her campaign come from herself and other individuals.

District 63: Anthony Rendon (D) vs. Maria Estrada (D)

• The district: District 63 is home to about 461,153 residents spread throughout the cities of Bell, Cudahy, Hawaiian Gardens, Lakewood, Lynwood, Maywood, Paramount, South Gate, and parts of Long Beach.

• The Incumbent: Rendon (D-Lakewood) has a history of voting for progressive measures on the environment, mild police oversight, and mild protections for tenants. Over his career, he has taken $218,000 from the pharmaceutical industry, over $347,000 from the insurance industry, and has accepted money from various law enforcement groups.

• The Challenger: Maria Estrada is running on a platform of Medicare-for-all, rent control, and environmental issues. She’s raised around $5,000 primarily from individual donors.

District 62: Autumn Burke (D) vs. Robert Steele (R)

• The district: District 62 is home to 466,713 people spread throughout the South Bay, Westside, and South L.A. It encompasses the cities of Del Aire, El Segundo, Hawthorne, Lawndale, Lennox, Venice, Marina Del Rey, West Athens, parts of Westchester, Gardena, Westmont, and most of Inglewood.

• The Incumbent: Autumn Burke has a record of voting progressively on a variety of issues. Over the years, she’s accepted over $109,000 in contributions from telecommunications companies like AT&T.

• The Challenger: Robert Steele is running on a Republican platform of building a border wall to keep undocumented Mexicans out, and expanding local law enforcement’s ability to work with federal law enforcement. Additionally, he is against mandatory vaccinations and universal healthcare. He is primarily funded by individual donations adding up to about $1,100.

District 59: Reginald Jones-Sawyer (D) vs. EfrenMartinez (D)

• The district: District 59 encompasses the areas of Florence-Graham, Florence, Historic South Central, University Park, Vermont-Slauson, Walnut Park, parts of Vermont Square, Exposition Park, and Huntington Park.

• The Incumbent: While Reginald “Reggie” Jones-Sawyer often votes in favor of progressive measures on the environment and tenants protections, he has a mixed record on police reform — perhaps the biggest issue on the minds of many voters this year. Criminal justice reform forms part of his platform this year, but he has also accepted over $60,000 from police unions like the LAPPL and the CCPOA.

• The Challenger: Efren Martinez lacks a clear position on a variety of issues, but speaks favorably of small businesses. He’s invested over $300,000 of his own money into his campaign, and has accepted a bit over $9,000 each from Davita and PORAC.

District 58: Cristina Garcia (D) vs. Margaret Villa (G)

• The District: Encompasses parts of the Gateway Cities along the 605 from Cerritos to Pico Rivera, and is home to about 468,258 people. Also included in this district are the cities of Artesia, Bell Gardens, Bellflower, Commerce, Downey, Montebello, Norwalk.

• The Incumbent: Cristina Garcia has a mixed record on housing and issues regarding internet access and affordability. In the past two years, she abstained from voting on bills that would prevent evictions and restore net neutrality, and voted in favor of a bill that eliminated oversight over telecoms companies. She’s accepted over $169,000 from the real estate industry, and $100,000 from telecoms companies.

• The Challenger: Margaret Villa is running on the Green Party ticket, with a platform of Medicare-for-all, and rent control/forgiveness. Thus far, Villa has only raised about $700.

District 57 Lisa Calderon (D) vs. Jessica Martinez (R)

• The District:Encompasses the Eastern portion of the Gateway Cities, including Avocado Heights, La Mirada, Hacienda Heights, Industry, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Norwalk, Santa Fe Springs, South El Monte, South San Jose Hills, South Whittier, West Whittier-Los Nietos, and Whittier proper.

• The Democrat: The Calderons are a California political dynasty in a time of rampant skepticism for establishment politicians. She’s running on a platform of half-measures — she supports expanding the ACA instead of Medicare-for-all, and wants to pass laws to clean up polluion rather than prevent it. Her policies seem to reflect the thousands of dollars in campaign contributions that she’s received from energy companies.

• The Republican: Jessica Martinez is a first-time candidate who says she wants to bring back jobs by lowering state taxes. A Trump supporter, Martinez posts videos on her campaign’s official Facebook declaring that systemic racism and White privilege aren’t real, and denouncing “left-wing indoctrination” in schools. One of her proposed plans for unhoused residents of Whittier is to designate an acre of land in an industrial area for them, install porta-johns and wash areas, and then strictly enforce vagrancy laws.

District 55 Phillip Chen (R) vs. Andrew Rodriguez (D)

• The District:Centered on Chino Hills, but also encompasses Brea, Diamond Bar, La Habra, Industry, Placenta, Rowland Heights, Walnut, West Covina, and Yorba Linda.

• The Incumbent: District 55 is one of the only districts in L.A. County that is currently represented by a Republican. Phillip Chen has received tens of thousands of dollars from police groups, energy companies, and bankers, and his time in office reflects these contributions to the letter.

• The Challenger: Andrew Rodriguez is running a fairly boilerplate Democratic platform without naming many specific policies. His approach to the urgent housing crisis seems to miss the crucial point that Southern California doesn’t face a lack of housing inventory, but that the inventory is priced far beyond the paychecks of everyday workers. His proposed solution is to incentivize production of new housing, but how he plans to combat sky-high market prices remains to be seen.

District 54: Sydney Kamlager (D) vs. Tracy Bernard Jones (D)

• The district: The diverse 54th district encompasses parts of L.A. County including Culver City, Ladera Heights, Baldwin Hills, Century City, Crenshaw, Leimert Park, Mar Vista, Mid-City L.A., West LA Westwood, View Park, and Windsor Hills.

• The Incumbent: Sydney Kamlager is running for reelection on criminal justice reform, and has authored bills that allow people on parole to vote. She has accepted over $17,000 from the California Apartment Association, which fights against measures like rent control, and the rights of tenants.

• The Challenger: Tracy Bernard Jones is a special education teacher focusing on education issues. He stands against charter schools and fracking, and he wants to expand the ACA in the state.

District 53: Miguel Santiago (D) vs. Godfrey Santos Plata (D)

• The district: The largely Latino 53rd District encompasses most of Downtown L.A., as well as areas of Huntington Park, Boyle Heights, Koreatown, Little Tokyo, Pico-Union, Westlake, and Vernon.

• The Incumbent: During his time in office Miguel Santiago has authored progressive measures to fight against climate change, rent hikes, and to open public banks. He’s received contributions from telecoms, energy, unions, and pharmaceutical companies.

• The Challenger: A gay immigrant from the Philippines, Godfrey Santos Plata is endorsed by community organizations fighting for economic and housing justice, such as Ground Game LA, Our Revolution LA, and the Sunrise Movement. He has pledged to not take any money from the police.

District 52: Freddie Rodriguez (D) vs. Toni Holle (R)

• District 52: The suburban 52nd district represents 465,678 people across parts of L.A. and San Bernardino counties, including Pomona, Chino, Montclair, and Ontario.

• The Incumbent: Since taking office in 2013, Rodriguez has become notorious for abstaining from difficult votes regarding affordable housing, climate change, the rights of workers, and mass incarceration, often in spite of support for such measures from his constituents. During his career he has accepted thousands in campaign contributions from big oil, big pharma, and law enforcement.

• The Challenger: Toni Holle is running on a platform of lowering taxes, increasing funding for the police, and ending mandatory vaccinations. She says that to help the homeless, we should not provide housing, but should put homeless people in drug treatment facilities — by force if necessary.

District 51: Wendy Carrillo (D), Unopposed

• Wendy Carrillo (D-Boyle Heights) is running unopposed in District 51.

District 50: Richard Bloom (D) vs. Will Hess (D)

• The district: The district’s 470,048 residents are spread across Agoura Hills, Beverly Hills, Bel Air, Brentwood, Hollywood, Mid-Wilshire, Pacific Palisades, Malibu, Santa Monica, Topanga, and West Hollywood.

• The Incumbent: Richard Bloom has held this seat since 2012, and has used his time in office to sponsor bills to protect tenants, including a failed bill to authorize rent control, and a recent bill that prevents COVID-19 related evictions until February 2021.

• The Challenger: Will Hess, perhaps better known for his 2010 documentary “With Great Power: The Stan Lee Story” is running a campaign with a mixed bag of views. One of the primary issues of his platform is eradicating homelessness — something he wants to achieve by building a large campus outside of L.A., where unhoused persons will get “three hots and a cot” along with access to medical care, job placement, social programs, and aid in moving to affordable housing. He’s against NIMBYs, illegal immigration, and Black Lives Matter. He’s for the Second Amendment, infrastructure expansion, and banning all Chinese investment in U.S. media.

District 49: Edwin Chau (D) vs. Burton Brink (R)

• The district:Parts of Alhambra, Arcadia, El Monte, Montebello, Monterey Park, Rosemead, San Gabriel, San Marino, South El Monte, and Temple City.

• The Incumbent: Edwin Chau is perhaps best known for introducing the California Consumer Privacy Act, which gives consumers the rght to deny sale of their data, and to know what data is being collected from them.

• The Challenger: The former deputy sheriff and Sgt. Burton Brink is running against Chau for the second term in a row, but it doesn’t appear that he’s gained much more ground. His largest campaign contributions came from various law enforcement agencies, and he is running on a platform of lowering taxes and fighting crime. He wants to bring businesses back to the San Gabriel Valley, strictly enforce immigration, and restore local control over education.

District 48: Blanca Rubio (D) — Unopposed

• Blanca Rubio (D-Baldwin Park) is running unopposed in District 48

District 46: Adrin Nazarian (D) vs. Lanira K. Murphy (D)

• The district:Includes portions of Hollywood Hills, Lake Balboa, North Hills, North Hollywood, Panorama City, Sherman Oaks, Studio City, Toluca Lake, Valley Glen, Valley Village, Van Nuys, and Universal City.

• The Incumbent: Adrin Nazarian is the first Iranian-American to be elected to the state Legislature. He sponsored AB3088, a recent stopgap measure to protect tenants from evictions.

• The Challenger: Lanira K. Murphy is a teacher-turned-treasurer of the Panorama City Neighborhood Council. She wants to repeal AB5, increase funding for education, and prioritize transparency in drug prices.

District 45: Jesse Gabriel (D) vs. Jeffi Girgenti (R)

• The district:Includes Calabasas, Hidden Hills, Canoga Park, Encino, Northridge, Reseda, West Hills, Winnetka, Woodland Hills, Tarzana, and Bell Canyon.

• The Incumbent: Jesse Gabriel, who twice sued the Trump administration over DACA, is now running for his second term in District 45. While a Democrat, he’s certainly not a progressive.

• The Challenger: Jeffi Girgenti, a small business owner, received over 900 write-in votes in the primary, and will be allowed to face Gabriel in the general due to the top two-system. She wants to repeal AB5, increase penalties for people with substance abuse disorders, and supports charter schools.

District 44: Jacqui Irwin (D) vs. Denise Pedrow (R)

• The district:Including Westlake Village, Camarillo, Moorpark, Oak Park, Oxnard, Port Hueneme, and Thousand Oaks.

• The Incumbent: Jacqui Irwin, the former Thousand Oaks mayor, is not a progressive Democrat, but skews center-

right on several issues.

• The Challenger: Republican opponent Denise Pedrow wants to shrink the government, lower taxes, and fund law enforcement. She stands against rent control, and wants to reopen churches for public worship.

District 43: Laura Friedman (D) vs. Mike Graves (R)

• The district:It encompasses the areas of Burbank, Glendale, La Cañada Flintridge, La Crescenta-Montrose, Hollywood Hills, East Hollywood, Little Armenia, Los Feliz, Silver Lake, and Atwater Village.

• The Incumbent: Laura Friedman has an outstanding record of voting in favor of progressive policies, and worked with other Democrats to sponsor bills to restrict use of force by law enforcement. She is the author of important bills to protect the environment, including one to reduce greenhouse gas emissions from commercial and residential buildings by 40% by 2030.

• The Challenger: Mike Graves owns a toffee house, and is tired of California's high taxes. He wants to increase local control of school districts, and lower the costs of government in the state. After opposing him for the first years of his presidency, Graves recently came out in favor of Donald Trump.

District 41: Chris Holden (D) vs. Robin A. Hvidston (R)

• The district: DIncluding Pasadena, La Verne, Monrovia, Pasadena, San Dimas, Sierra Madre, South Pasadena, Rancho Cucamonga, San Antonio Heights, and Upland.

• The Incumbent: Chris Holden, the former mayor and city councilmember of Pasadena, has an outstanding record of voting in favor of progressive policies, and recently has sponsored bills to restrict the use of force by law enforcement. He was instrumental in connecting Pasadena to L.A. with the Metro Gold Line.

• The Challenger: Robin Hvidston says she is pro-law enforcement, pro-business, and wants to build the border wall. She opposes any plan to change Prop 13.

District 39: Luz Rivas (D) vs. Ricardo Benitez (R)

• The district:Arleta, Lake View Terrace, Mission Hills, North Hollywood, Pacoima, Sun Valley, Sunland-Tujunga, Sylmar, and San Fernando.

• The Incumbent: Luz Rivas, the former L.A. Public Works Commissioner, usually votes in favor of progressive policies, and is endorsed by Mayor Eric Garcetti. She beat Benitez in the 2018 election for the same seat.

• The Challenger: Ricardo Benitez operates a contracting business, has unsuccessfully run for various offices over the last decade. This year he was a plaintiff in a suit filed against Gov. Gavin Newsom over a statewide assistance program meant to help immigrants not covered by the CARES Act.

District 38: Suzette Martinez Valladares (R) vs. Lucie Lapointe Volotzky (R)

• The district:Encompasses Agua Dulce, Castaic, Granada Hills, Porter Ranch, Santa Clarita, Stevenson Ranch, and Simi Valley.

• The challenger: Suzette Martinez Valladares is one of two Republican nominees for District 38 this year. The granddaughter of a Bakersfield farmworker, she is endorsed by the LAPPL and other law enforcement groups. She says she wants to focus on early childhood education and advocacy.

• The challenger: Lucie Lapointe Volotzky is the other Republican to emerge from the top-two primary earlier this year. She is in favor of charter schools, wants to reduce tuition costs for students forced to take their university

education online, she wants to be tough on crime, and vows that she will not vote for new taxes.

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